

Bob Ingram

'As I Was Saying ...'

Close to Magic Time

MONDAY MUSINGS. We've never seen a four-minute or sub-four minute mile in El Paso as far as human foot racers are concerned. But it's coming. Kerry Ellison of UTEP almost did it Saturday night in the Western Athletic Conference meet. He ran it in 4:02.1. Next time he runs, it may happen.

The Miners buried the field in the Western Athletic Conference meet, scoring 177 points to second place Brigham Young's 108.

Track and field was the main event of the WAC spring festivities held here and winning it was the most prestigious thing that could happen to any school.

It makes up for the fact that although UTEP was the host school, there were no Miner teams competing in tennis and golf.

Let's hope it isn't too long before UTEP has enough finances to put out teams in all sports, swimming, wrestling and gymnastics included as well as tennis and golf.

And, oh, yes, you hear it from some lips that it would be a good idea if UTEP had a baseball team.

Upgrading the Miners in baseball is in the works, as it certainly should be. It's not good that they should be a laughing-stock to Arizona teams.

Andy Cohen's kids did try and they finally succeeded in winning their first Western Athletic Conference game of the season, beating New Mexico in 10 innings. Had there been any money available, it might have been a champagne victory for the down-trodden Miners.

Interference Play

"I DREAMED ABOUT that play all night," said Monty Basgall, the Sun Dodgers manager.

He was talking about the interference play that occurred in the ninth inning of Saturday night's game with the San Antonio Brewers at Dudley Field.

Three El Paso base runners helped set the stage for this intriguing situation. There were no outs. San Antonio led 8-7.

Lee Robinson was at bat for El Paso. He hit a dribbler that the pitcher, Gary Cavallo, of San Antonio, fielded and threw to home, forcing Terry McDermott.

Then Dennis Parks, the San Antonio catcher, threw to first base. It looked like Robinson had time to beat the play. Also, the throw hit him in the back. But umpire Bill Finnegan ruled he ran out of the base line. Interference was called and he was out amidst protests of Basgall.

Jesus Aristumuno, at third for the Sun Dodgers, attempted to come home right after the throw was made on Robinson. He was tagged out at home. It looked like a triple play. But the ball was ruled dead after the call on Robinson's interference. Aristumuno went back to third.

Pinch-hitter Larry Eckenrode grounded out. That ended the inning and game and spoiled a fine chance of the Sun Dodgers pulling the game out of the fire.

Short Sacrifice Fly

IT WAS A NIGHT of weird plays. A windstorm that came up and which blew into the faces of the batters made catching fly balls hazardous.

In one unusual play, Lee Lacy of the Sun Dodgers scored from third on a sacrifice fly—to the shortstop, Bob Ellis. It was a fly ball hit between the infield and outfield. Ellis raced toward it and caught the ball over his shoulder. He juggled the ball once. Lacy took off from third and beat the throw to the plate. The fact that Ellis had to turn around to throw made his job difficult and Lacy is the fastest man on the Sun Dodger team, too.